Mariano Marcos State University
SDG 15 · Life on Land

STORYBOARD · CHAPTER 04 OF 13

04

Educating communities about ecosystems

5 frames

THE STORY

Teaching communities to grow and guard what the land holds: mangroves, indigenous trees and food plants.

MMSU'S COMMITMENT

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

THE FILMSTRIP · 5 FRAMES

2025 Ongoing programme


1


2


3


4


5

AT A GLANCE

64
farmers trained (Sarrat)

4
coastal towns trained

2nd
foodscape batch



Representatives of Currimao, Pasuquin, Badoc and Burgos at the Seminar-Workshop on Mangrove Propagation, 27–28 October 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Hands-on mangrove nursery and propagation practice during the seminar-workshop. (Photo: MMSU)

27–28 OCT 2025 · MMSU CENTER FOR FLEXIBLE LEARNING

MMSU Trains Coastal Towns on Mangrove Propagation, Management and Conservation

1. **THE TRAINING**
   A two-day Seminar-Workshop on Mangrove Propagation for representatives of Currimao, Pasuquin, Badoc and Burgos, with DENR-PENRO officials in attendance, under the DOST-PCAARRD NbS mangrove project.
2. **THE CURRICULUM**
   Importance of mangrove ecosystems, nature-based solutions, legal frameworks for protection, and the roles of academe and LGUs in community-based management.
3. **HANDS-ON**
   Nursery management and advanced propagation of Avicennia and Sonneratia and other local mangroves; the Pedada People's Organization shared its community-based conservation experience.

2	4	2
days	coastal towns	mangrove genera named

Source: MMSU News, "MMSU trains Ilocos Norte coastal towns on mangrove propagation and management," 5 November 2025



Farmers and local officials trained on alukon (himbabao) propagation, Brgy. 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, 2 May 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

2 MAY 2025 · BRGY. 11 STA. ROSA, SARRAT, ILOCOS NORTE

Farmers in Sarrat Trained to Propagate the Indigenous Alukon

1. **THE TRAINING**
   The Research and Extension Directorates trained 64 farmers on propagating alukon (himbabao), a Philippine indigenous vegetable tree, in response to community requests.
2. **WHO ATTENDED**
   Barangay officials, members of the Task Force Dagger Special Operations Foundation and LGU representatives also attended.
3. **THE EXPERTISE**
   Dr. Menisa Antonio, Engr. Josefa Pugat and Mr. Jayson Rasay presented propagation strategies for sustained alukon production and wider use for food and other applications.

64
farmers trained

Source: MMSU News, “MMSU trains Sarrat farmers on alukon propagation,” 9 May 2025



MMSU Information and Technology Caravan at the 2025 Siwawer Farmers' Festival, Vintar, 3–4 December 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

3–4 DEC 2025 · VINTAR PUBLIC AUDITORIUM, ILOCOS NORTE

MMSU Brings Bamboo and Alukon Propagation to the 2025 Siwawer Farmers' Festival

1. **THE EVENT**
   MMSU's Information and Technology Caravan joined the 2025 Siwawer Farmers' Festival and Agro-Trade Fair with an exhibit of university technologies and a series of expert lectures.
2. **DAY 1 · BAMBOO**
   Forester Shena Rose Garcia introduced sustainable bamboo production using MMSU's one-node cutting technology.
3. **DAY 2 · ALUKON**
   Ms. Josefa Pugat demonstrated propagation of the indigenous vegetable tree alukon; other lectures covered glutinous corn varieties, garlic disease management and black garlic.

2
days

Source: MMSU News, "MMSU IT caravan goes to Vintar," 15 December 2025



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

OCTOBER 2025 · WORLD FOOD DAY · SAN NICOLAS, ILOCOS NORTE

Community Foodscapes as Learning Gardens for Indigenous Plants

1. **THE SITE**
   The Extension and Research Directorates set up the second batch of Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks at Eladio V. Barangan Memorial Elementary School.

2. **WHO TOOK PART**
   Barangay officials of San Roque and Parut (Vintar), agricultural extension workers, school leaders and community representatives.

3. **THE LEARNING**
   Seedbanks and learning gardens that encourage knowledge sharing; communities receive planting materials and technical assistance for kapaskapas, alokon, pako, dalayap, wild singkamas and roselle.

2nd	6
batch of foodscapes	indigenous crops

Source: MMSU Extension Directorate, “MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs,” October 2025 · MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking



Capture: Philippine News Agency post of 6 June 2026 on indigenous food plants propagated at the MMSU NRCMC botanical garden (photos: Leilanie Adriano, PNA).



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

6 JUN 2026 · MMSU NATURAL RESOURCES CONSERVATION AND MANAGEMENT CENTER, BATAC

Indigenous Food Plants Propagated at the MMSU Botanical Garden Are Shared with Schools and Communities

Ongoing programme · Philippine News Agency, 6 June 2026

1. **THE REPORT**
   The Philippine News Agency reported that sugod-sugod, alokon, buga and karot are being propagated at the NRCMC botanical garden.
2. **THE SHARING**
   Planting materials go to schools and community stakeholders for food gardens, to boost food security and give farmers an additional income source.
3. **THE LINK**
   The garden is the ex situ arm of the IFP Program, which in 2025 extended community foodscapes and seedbanks to new partner barangays.

Source: Philippine News Agency, Facebook post on indigenous food plants at the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center botanical garden, 6 June 2026

WHERE THE STORY LANDS

Coastal towns learn mangrove propagation, Sarrat farmers learn to propagate alukon, and schools and barangays receive learning gardens: knowledge of wild flora and ecosystems goes out to the communities that live beside them.

64	4	2nd
farmers trained (Sarrat)	coastal towns trained	foodscape batch

THE FRAMES

1. **MMSU Trains Coastal Towns on Mangrove Propagation, Management and Conservation**
   27–28 Oct 2025
2. **Farmers in Sarrat Trained to Propagate the Indigenous Alukon**
   2 May 2025
3. **MMSU Brings Bamboo and Alukon Propagation to the 2025 Siwawer Farmers' Festival**
   3–4 Dec 2025
4. **Community Foodscapes as Learning Gardens for Indigenous Plants**
   October 2025
5. **Indigenous Food Plants Propagated at the MMSU Botanical Garden Are Shared with Schools and Communities**
   6 Jun 2026

SOURCES (6)

1. MMSU News, "MMSU trains Ilocos Norte coastal towns on mangrove propagation and management," 5 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2670/mmsu-trains-ilocos-norte-coastal-towns-on-mangrove-propagation-and-management
2. MMSU News, "MMSU trains Sarrat farmers on alukon propagation," 9 May 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-trains-sarrat-farmers-on-alukon-propagation
3. MMSU News, "MMSU IT caravan goes to Vintar," 15 December 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-it-caravan-goes-to-vintar
4. MMSU Extension Directorate, "MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs," October 2025 https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus
5. MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking
6. Philippine News Agency, Facebook post on indigenous food plants at the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center botanical garden, 6 June 2026 https://www.facebook.com/pnagovph/posts/1411199747723142/